Management

Treatment Modalities

- No satisfactory treatment is available till today. No drugs available to increase intelligence.
- Behaviour and environmental supervision
- Monitoring the child's developmental needs and problems.
- Programs that maximize speech, language, cognitive, psychomotor, social, self-care, and occupational skills.
- Ongoing evaluation for overlapping psychiatric disorders
- Family therapy and Early intervention programs for children
- Provide day schools to train the child in basic skills, such as bathing, brushing and eating.

Prevention of Mental Retardation

- Genetic counselling, avoid consanguinity marriages.
- Good perinatal care and hospital deliveries
- Avoiding marriages of mentally retarded
- Early diagnosis and treatment.

Rehabilitation

Rehabilitation is aimed at

- Physical (appliances for handicaps),
- Social (social skills training) and
- Occupational areas (e.g. by teaching and training the patients to make them self-sufficient).
- Day care centres and schools, integrated schools, vocational training centres, sheltered forms and workshops are useful.

Tips for Parents of Mentally Challenged Children:

- Mental retardation will not be caused by sin, god's anger.
- Do not consider them as a burden.
- Home training will give good result.
- Home is the best place to train the child.
- Home training will lead to independent life



Do you know an Indian girl who holds the world record for highest IQ level?

K. Visalini, 19 year old female from Tirunelveli. Her IQ level is **225**.



TEACHER ACTIVITY

Make a field visit to nearby mental retardation school and orient the training of mentally challenged children and their parents.

Social welfare schemes available for mentally retarded in India

- Monthly maintenance charge of Rs.1000/-
- Self-employment subsidy to persons through banks, and free travel concession with one escort, free special education, appointment of legal guardianship, homes and vocational training programme from non-governmental organizations are available.

10.9 Learning Disability

Difficulties with reading, writing and/or math are recognizable problems during the school ages, the signs and symptoms of learning disabilities are most often diagnosed during that time. Learning disabilities are referred to as **"hidden disabilities".** The person looks perfectly "normal" and seems to be a very bright and intelligent person, yet may be unable to demonstrate the skill level expected from someone of a similar age. Children with learning disabilities are as smart as or smarter than their peers.

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